within driving distance of Kaziranga. Its upcoming properties include Jawai, Kanha, Pench, and Bandhavgarh, while discussions are underway for Kabini, Tadoba, and Ranthambore.

"We are not looking at these as individual hotels. We are creating a circuit," says Chopra.

Chopra believes India's finest wildlife lodges can eventually command rates comparable to similar international properties. While leading African safari lodges can charge $1,500-3,000 a night, India has historically struggled to achieve similar pricing in most wildlife markets. In India, the average is $500-600, going up to $1000-1200, with exceptions like SUJÁN Jawai that go up to $2000.

"Create the right product and I believe travellers, both Indian and international, will pay for it," he says.

BIG BRANDS MOVE IN

ITC hotels is similarly expanding its wildlife presence, particularly through its experiential hospitality brand Storii.

Anil Chadha, Managing Director, ITC Hotels Ltd says the expansion reflects changing consumer preferences. "The premiumisation of travel is creating greater appetite for intimate, differentiated experiences," says Chadha.



"The objective is not simply to replicate an urban luxury hotel in a wilderness setting but to design a proposition that is appropriate to the destination"

ANIL CHADHA
MANAGING DIRECTOR, ITC HOTELS



The company has opened Storii in Jawai and Sanjay Dubri while signing new developments in Ranthambore, Sasan Gir and Dhari Gir. Its wider wildlife portfolio extends across Jim Corbett, Tadoba, Pench, and Bera (Pali) through brands such as Welcomhotel, Welcom-Heritage, and Fortune.

For Chadha, wildlife hospitality is an important